

The next thing you know, you have siblings and cousins feuding against each other.

A BROTHER'S BETRAYAL AND THE LIQUIDATION OF THE WAXMAN FAMILY BUSINESS

Sometimes conflicting personalities can, eventually, cause a shocking betrayal among family members. This is what led to the unfortunate demise of the Waxman family business.

Isaac Waxman was a Jewish Polish immigrant to Ontario, Canada, in 1911. He was fired from his first job for refusing to work on the Sabbath. So he bought a horse and carriage and started collecting bottles, cans, and scrap metal for recycling. He worked for 11 years before he had earned enough to bring his wife and five children from Poland. He and his wife then had four more children, two of whom, Morris and Chester, joined their father's business.

They were able to grow I. Waxman and Sons into a successful recycling company, selling scrap to the city's booming steel mills.²

The brothers worked well together. Chester was the more outgoing of the two, and he handled sales and the financial side of the business. The elder brother, Morris, ran the yard, managing the large volume of business that Chester brought in.

They won contracts with large manufacturers such as Firestone. And the brothers built up a good reputation in the city.

The brothers bought matching Cadillacs for themselves and lavish gifts for their wives.

But trouble was brewing.

Chester was more ambitious, charismatic, and aggressive than Morris. He felt that he was mainly responsible for the success of the business and deserved a larger share of it.